

Hymns & Spirituals





About the Course

Students sing hymns and spirituals to build their faith and appreciation of God's work across time. Hymns and spirituals are connected to the historical time period as appropriate.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Music: Intro, Music: Level 1, Music: Level 2, Music: Level 3, Music: Level 4, Music: Level 5

Hymns & Spirituals

The Christian hymn and spiritual tradition is incredibly rich, and it is vanishing from many churches. In addition to bringing a much-needed moment of peace to your day, hymns can also introduce students to important theological ideas and church liturgy.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
1-12	Hymns & Spirituals 1 time/week 10 min	Our Hymns, Our Heritage

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Music: Intro				
Sol-fa: Musical Games	Hymns & Spirituals Afternoon Listening		Folk Songs	Music Appreciation
Music: Level 1				
Sol-fa: Level 1	Hymns & Spirituals Afternoon Listening		Folk Songs	Composer Study
Music: Level 2				
Sol-fa: Level 2	Hymns & Spirituals	Folk Songs	Composer Study Afternoon Listening	
Music: Level 3				
Sol-fa: Level 3 Afternoon Listening		Hymns & Spirituals	Folk Songs	Composer Study
Music: Level 4				
Sol-fa: Level 4 Afternoon Listening		Hymns & Spirituals	Folk Songs	Composer Study
Music: Level 5				
Sol-fa: Level 5 Afternoon Listening	Hymns & Spirituals	Folk Songs	Composer Study	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Hymns & Spirituals

□ Bookmark the Alveary hymns, spirituals, and folk song playlist for the year, or create your own YouTube, Spotify, or Amazon playlist if desired.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Hymns & Spirituals



Our Work: Grades 1-2



Our Work: Grade 3



Our Work: Grades 4-6



Our Work: Grades 7-8



Our Work: Grades 9-12



Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs PDF



Our Hymns, Our Heritage



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Hymns & Spirituals

∞ [Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs PDF](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Hymns & Spirituals

How To Teach



Recap

- Specific recap questions are often suggested in the day's plans; ask students what they remember from the last lesson. If nothing comes to mind at first, tell them to give themselves another minute or two and to keep thinking. Our brains are amazing and can usually recall the previous lesson with a minute of effort. Refrain from doing the work of remembering yourself if you are leading the lessons.
- For composer study, a recap might look like a brief discussion about the name or sound of the piece you listened to previously.
- For hymns and folk songs, this might be an effort to hum the melody or recite the words of the song you're currently learning.
- For sol-fa, it might be a quick explanation of the sol-fa syllable you learned or a tricky rhythm or interval you were working to master.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture or sharing something that the teacher remembers. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then teachers may consider continuing anyway or repeating the last lesson.



Introduce

- Prepare to listen to the day's musical selection by inviting students to consider an interesting musical or historical idea in the lesson. Perhaps it's a unique word, rhythm, instrument, or piece of historical background. You might introduce it by the way, or read a selection of a composer's bio or a brief article to students.



Listen & Sing

- Listen to the day's musical selection.
- Composer study lessons will usually have you listen to a piece of music for 3-8 minutes. If students have a difficult time listening for the duration of the lesson, stop the music at their limit.
- Some students might draw, color, or engage in a handicraft while listening to help extend their listening time. Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Hymn, folk song, or sol-fa lessons will sometimes have you listen to a part of the song and then practice echoing back the melody and/or words.



Discuss

- **Composer Study:** Talk about the musical selection you heard. What stood out to you? What did you notice? What did it make you wonder? Did it remind you of anything? Discuss the tempo, the sound of the music, the instruments used, the volume, and the mood. Why do you think the composer wrote it the way he did?
- **Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs:** What lines strike you particularly? Is there a rhyme scheme to the lyrics? Is there a progression to each stanza? If you were to add a verse to the song, what would you add? If you took a verse out, how do you think it would change the song? Do the melody and words go together? Why or why not?
- **Sol-fa:** Take a minute to reflect on what you learned in the lesson. Write down any notes you want to remember and practice any particular exercises that were tricky.



Connect

- At the end of the lesson, think about how the day's musical selection connects to other books, subjects, characters in history, etc.
- You might copy down a stanza of a hymn in your Commonplace or Copywork book, read a bit more about the history behind a piece of music, jot down a noteworthy date in your Book of Centuries, or discuss a broader question raised in the lesson.

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Term 1

WEEK 1 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 1

How Firm a Foundation

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage, Our Work Book, and/or Music Selections Booklet

→ INTRO

Our first hymn this year is called "How Firm a Foundation." What is a foundation, and what do you think this hymn will be about?

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Today, focus on getting familiar with the hymn. Read the words aloud and listen to the full song. Note that various recordings sometimes use the older "thee" rather than "you" and annotate your lyrics depending on the recording you use. Notice, talk about, and look up any unfamiliar words.

∞ Audio Link: How Firm a Foundation (YouTube or Spotify)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Learn the history of the song from Our Hymns, Our Heritage. "Text and Tune" p.136

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Look at early copies of Rippon's hymnal. What differences and similarities do you notice between it and hymnals today? If interested, read the original hymn (note the extra verses which are less common today) and the prefaces.

∞ **Book Links:** 1801 and 1828 versions

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Use your preferred recording to listen to the hymn in the afternoons, evenings, or anytime! The more you spend time with it, the more the words will sink into your head and your heart.

• IMPORTANT DATE

"How Firm a Foundation" published in Rippon's hymnal (1787 AD).

WEEK 2 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 2

How Firm a Foundation (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Music PDF or Our Work Book, Bible

→ RECAP

What is the name of the hymn for this term, and what is it about? Tell anything else you remember about its history.

→ SING

Practice the tune by first listening to a verse, then humming the next two.

∞ Video Link: How Firm a Foundation Full Song

→ READ & DISCUSS

Let's focus on the lyrics a bit more. Read the whole song aloud, then look up the Bible verses below (mentioned last week in your hymnal) and tell what you notice about the images, ideas, or even direct words that the hymn writer used from each verse.

\- Isaiah 41:10 (Stanza 2)

\- Isaiah 43:2 (Stanza 3 & 4)

\- Zechariah 13:9 (Stanza 4)

\- John 10:27-29, Romans 8:38-39, Hebrews 13:5-6 (Stanza 5)

★ TEACHER TIP

If teaching in a classroom setting, assign verses to various students to keep this part of the lesson from taking too long.

• EXTRA HELPING

More on the song's history and how the author used bible verses in his composition. Note the additional verse

∞ **Video Link:** Hymn Story, Analysis, Performance

Hymns & Spirituals

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Term 1

→ (OPTIONAL) COPYWORK (GRADES 4+)

Write one of the Bible verses above underneath your hymn lyrics or in your copywork book.

WEEK 3 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 3

How Firm a Foundation (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Music PDF or Our Work Book

→ RECAP

Sing the tune of How Firm a Foundation on "hoo" and read the words aloud. Pay attention to the meaning and punctuation as you read.

→ SING & DISCUSS

Today, listen to a line of the song, then pause the video and echo it back, working your way line by line through the song. This will help you focus on each line of the song, not just the ones which come easily to you.

∞ Video Link: How Firm a Foundation Full Song

- What images or lines in the song do you like best?

→ COPYWORK (GRADE 4+)

Copy a line of the melody into your music journal and (if you are taking sol-fa), see if you can label the notes with the sol-fa syllables. Hint: it is written in the key of G, and the first note is "So." Count up how many different sol-fa syllables you used in the song [there should be five]. This hymn is written using the pentatonic scale (often a major scale omitting fa and ti). Many other hymns (like Amazing Grace) are also written with only these five different sol-fa syllables. Explore Extra Helpings to explore a music theory rabbit hole on pentatonic music.

WEEK 4 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 4

How Firm a Foundation (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Music PDF or Our Work Book

∞ GATHER SUPPLIES: Paints or sketching materials

→ RECAP

Recite the hymn (as much as able).

→ SING

Try to sing the whole song with the accompaniment. Note the areas where you aren't as sure of the tune or the words.

∞ Video Link: How Firm a Foundation Tune

→ ILLUSTRATE

★ TEACHER TIP

If a student has a hard time coming up with an idea for an illustration, encourage them to focus on just one image from a verse to illustrate. There are no wrong illustrations as long as the student connects it to an aspect of the verse in their mind. The purpose is simply to help them inhabit and reflect on the verse in a different way.

Hymns & Spirituals

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Term 1

With remaining time (and feel free to continue on your own time if desired), sketch or paint an illustration for each verse in your music notebook or alongside your lyrics.

WEEK 5 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 5

How Firm a Foundation (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Music PDF or Our Work Book

→ RECAP

Sing hymn from memory (as able).

→ SING

Now that you know the words better, experiment with how you sing the song. Pick a few ideas to try or come up with your own. Think about how to emphasize the meaning of the words by the way you sing different verses. Are there other instruments you would use? Use the recording as needed.

- Sing some verses faster or slower.
- Sing some parts soft and some loud.
- Sing the song as a 2-part canon. To do this, divide into two groups (if with at least two people) or use the recording as your second person if solo. Group 1 should start singing, and then Group 2 begins at the beginning when Group 1 hits the "tion" in "foundation" in the first line (see #57 in Our Hymns, Our Heritage to see where Group 2 comes in). Because of the way the song is composed, the two groups will sound nice together even while singing different words!

∞ Audio Link: How Firm a Foundation Tune

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Experiment with more than two groups singing this hymn in a canon or round, and try starting at different places to see what sounds best. For instance, Group 2 could wait to start until Group 1 begins the second line of music in your hymnal. Or you could try having four different groups!

WEEK 6 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 6

Children of the Heavenly Father

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage

(Optional) PREP: Read p.170 in your hymnal and the longer article about Lina and mark additional sections to share.

∞ Article Link: More about Lina

→ RECAP

Warm up your voice by singing "How Firm a Foundation."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

You might not have heard of our second hymn this term, but it is a beautiful reminder of God's love for his children. Read from the hymnal and share any additional sections from the article as desired (older students can read the article directly).

Our Hymns, Our Heritage, "Text and Tune" p.170

→ LISTEN, PRACTICE, & DISCUSS

• IMPORTANT DATE

Carolina Sandell Berg (Sweden, 1823-1903 AD)

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Listen to the song in the original Swedish (and feel free to learn the song in Swedish instead of English if you'd rather!).

∞ YouTube Links: Tryggare kan ingen vara

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Term 1

Bookmark #74 in Our Hymns, Our Heritage, and read the English words aloud. Then listen to the full song.

∞ Video Link: Children of the Heavenly Father YouTube

∞ Audio Link: Children of the Heavenly Father Spotify

- What did you think of the song after hearing a bit about Lina's life?
- Discuss any unfamiliar words.

WEEK 7 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 7

Children of the Heavenly Father (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF, Globe or World Atlas

→ RECAP & MAPWORK

- What is "Children of the Heavenly Father" about?
- Locate Sweden on your atlas or globe. Can you find Småland or Stockholm?

→ READ & SING

- Read the lyrics aloud.
 - Write down the beginning of each verse to help you remember the order.
 - Work on the tune by alternating between listening and humming with the verses. Slow down and pause the tune after each line and hum the melody back if you run into any tricky spots.
- ∞ Music Links: Children of the Heavenly Father (YouTube or Spotify)

→ DISCUSS

Can you think of any Bible stories or verses that Lina might have thought of when she wrote this song? [One option to read and discuss: Isaiah 40:11 and see the Extra Helping link for additional reflections on each verse]

• EXTRA HELPINGS

∞ Article Link: Reflections on CoftHF

WEEK 8 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 8

Children of the Heavenly Father (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you recite or sing the first verse without looking at the lyrics?

→ SING

Practice singing "Children of the Heavenly Father" today. If you can hum the whole tune from memory, sing the words along with the recording. If you are still working on the melody, pause the video after each line and sing it back. This will help you learn the song in its entirety.

∞ Music Links: Children of the Heavenly Father (YouTube or Spotify)

→ WRITE OR ILLUSTRATE

- Describe or start to sketch an illustration for each verse of the song, OR (Grades 6+) pick a verse from the song and rewrite it in your own words.

• COMPOSITION (Grades 7+)
Paraphrase the rest of the song in prose (or feel free to write a poetic paraphrase!).



Term 1

WEEK 9 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 9

Children of the Heavenly Father (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF, Globe or US Atlas

→ RECAP

Recite "Children of the Heavenly Father" (as able), and mark any spots that need work.

→ SING

Warm up your voice by humming a favorite song, then sing "Children of the Heavenly Father" with the accompaniment (without looking at the words if you can!). Don't worry if you make a mistake; just keep going and then go back afterward to check the words and sing the song again.

∞ Video Link: Children of the Heavenly Father Tune

→ READ & DISCUSS

Tell what you know about events happening around the world in the 1800s from anything you've learned in other subjects.

One of the reasons this hymn became so popular not only in Swedish but in English was due to two things: the famous soprano Jenny Lind who toured in North America and sang some of Lina's songs and the number of Swedes who immigrated to North America. We'll learn more about Jenny Lind next lesson.

∞ Article Link: Swedish Immigration

WEEK 10 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 10

Children of the Heavenly Father (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you still sing "How Firm a Foundation" from the first part of the term?

→ SING & DISCUSS

- Sing the song without the accompaniment. Then check yourself with the tune and lyrics.
- Sing the song again and experiment. Although many recordings play the melody quite slowly, aspects of the tune feel more like a lullaby or dance. Try singing it like a lullaby, and play with the dynamics (speed, volume, etc.). What type of singing best fits each verse?

∞ Video Link: Children of the Heavenly Father Tune

→ (OPTIONAL) LISTEN & DISCUSS

Jenny Lind was a sensational singer and devout Christian from Sweden (and recently fictionalized in *The Greatest Showman*). She popularized Carolina Berg's melodies in her concerts. With the remaining time, learn more about

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Listen to a beautiful choir arrangement of Children of the Heavenly Father!

∞ Audio Link: Dan Forrest Arrangement

Hymns & Spirituals

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

Jenny's tour via video or article.

∞ Article Link: About Jenny Lind (Article)

∞ Video Link: About Jenny Lind (Video)

WEEK 11 📅 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 11

Term Recap

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Try to recite both hymns from the term.

→ SING

Sing both of the term's hymns as if you were a soloist (you may choose to sing with or without the accompaniment).

∞ Video Link: How Firm a Foundation Tune

∞ Video Link: Children of the Heavenly Father Tune

WEEK 12 📅 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE.

Questions will come from:
Hymns & Spirituals

Hymns & Spirituals

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 13

Angels We Have Heard On High

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF, Bible

→ INTRO

What do you know about the scene where the angels came to the shepherds to tell them about Jesus? If you haven't read it before, look up Luke 2:6-20.

Our first song this term depicts this meeting!

→ READ, DISCUSS, & LISTEN

Read the lyrics aloud and discuss any unfamiliar words; then listen to the whole song.

∞ Music Links: Angels We Have Heard (YouTube OR Spotify)

→ READ & NARRATE

Learn the history of the song from your hymnal.

"Text and Tune" p.30

• IMPORTANT DATE

Angels We Have Heard on High published (1855 AD in French; 1862 AD in English)

• EXTRA HELPINGS

The history of this hymn is more complex than the hymnal's condensed version. With various translations and up to twelve original stanzas, the carol's many evolutions show how popular it became in both French and English!

∞ **Article Link:** History of Translation

∞ **Article Link:** French Lyrics (includes a more direct English translation).

WEEK 2 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 14

Angels We Have Heard On High (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

What is "Angels We Have Heard On High" about?

→ STUDY & SING

Today, we're focusing on learning the tune and words separately.

- Even if you can't read music, look at the music in your hymnal and notice that the shape of the top notes in the first line is the same as the second line. So once you learn the tune of the first line of music, you've learned the tune for the rest of the verse!

- Now find the first "Deo" you see in the sheet music. Even though it looks like a lot of notes, you'll see in your Our Work book or Music PDF and notice in the music that for the chorus you sing "Gloria in excelsis Deo" twice. And the only note that is different the second time is the very last note of the song.

- Now listen to the song and pay attention to those repeated lines (feel free to highlight them with different colors or make a note in your lyrics if desired)! Hum along with the recording as you pick up the tune.

∞ Video Link: Angels We Have Heard (YouTube or Spotify)

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read the words of the song aloud either in your hymnal, Our Work, or Music pdf.

• MUSICAL NOTE

When you sing "Gloria" in the chorus, you are singing a melisma – many notes on one syllable. While this is common for songs featuring just one artist, it is uncommon for congregational songs. Can you think of any other melismas in songs you've sung? Melismas are sometimes called "runs" or "riffs" in pop music.

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Term 2

WEEK 3 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 15

Angels We Have Heard On High (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you sing the chorus of "Angels We Have Heard on High"?

→ SING

We're putting the tune and text together today, so listen to a line of the hymn, then pause and sing it back. If you feel confident in the words, you can sing along; echoing helps us pay attention to each line.

∞ Video Link: Angels We Have Heard (YouTube or Spotify)

→ DISCUSS

Look back at the story in Luke 2 about the angels coming to the shepherds. If you wrote your own poetic/musical retelling of the story, what aspects of the story would you write about in your verses?

• **COMPOSITION** (Grades 7+)
Write your own retelling of the angels' and shepherds' meeting. You can write it as a poem or carol like "Angels We Have Heard on High," a play, a picture book, or a short story.

Extra challenge: Use a commentary or other study helps from Bible lessons to read more about shepherds in NT times and other aspects of Luke's narrative. Work to incorporate these details into your composition as you imagine what that meeting between angels and shepherds was like for those who were there.

WEEK 4 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 16

Angels We Have Heard On High (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Recite "Angels We Have Heard On High" from memory (as able).

→ SING

Sing the song with the accompaniment. Note: the accompaniment plays four verses, so you can stop after verse 3 (we're learning the most famous three verses, but as with many carols, others were penned by various translators and authors over the years).

∞ Video Link: Angels We Have Heard Tune

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Pick a recording below to hear another way an artist has made this carol their own and attempted to convey its message.

∞ Audio Link: Celtic Women

∞ Audio Link: Aretha Franklin

• MUSICAL NOTE

"Angels We Have Heard on High" is a macaronic song, meaning that it uses two different languages (English and Latin) in the same song. Can you think of any other macaronic songs (older or newer)?

WEEK 5 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 17

Angels We Have Heard On High (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Try singing "Angels We Have Heard On High" from memory.



Term 2

→ SING

Review any places or spots you forgot while trying to sing from memory. Sing the song again with or without the accompaniment and experiment with how you sing it. For instance, perhaps you sing the last verse very loudly since it's as if the shepherds are calling for everyone to come to worship Jesus! Add some notes for yourself in your music journal or lyric PDF on how you want to sing each verse (how loud, fast, what emotions you want to convey, etc.).

∞ Video Link: Angels We Have Heard Tune

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

"Angels from the Realms of Glory" is another carol that reflects on similar themes. Some even think it is an alternate translation of the same original French song that produced "Angels We Have Heard on High."

∞ Video Link: Angels from the Realms of Glory

WEEK 6 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 18

O Worship the King

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing "Angels We Have Heard on High" from memory (if you want to challenge yourself, try singing the verses in reverse order!).

→ READ & LISTEN

We're starting a new song!

- Read the lyrics in your Our Work/Music Booklet or #79 in your hymnal.
- Discuss any unfamiliar words.
- Listen to the hymn (note that V2 has an additional chorus you would want to add to your lyrics).

∞ Music Links: O Worship the King (YouTube V1, V2, or Spotify)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Learn the history of the song from your hymnal and/or this short video as time allows.

"Text & Tune" p.182

∞ Video Link: History of O Worship the King

• TERMINOLOGY

- **pavilioned:** enclosed, encircled
- **girded:** dressed

• IMPORTANT DATE

Robert Grant (England/India, 1779-1838 AD)

WEEK 7 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 19

O Worship the King (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP & MAPWORK

- What do you remember about our new song?
- Locate Mumbai, India (called Bombay during Sir Robert Grant's time) on your globe/atlas.

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Term 2

→ PRACTICE & SING

- Read the words aloud and work on learning them.
- Then work on the tune by alternating between listening to a verse and then humming along with the recording.
- ∞ Music Links: O Worship the King (YouTube V1, V2, or Spotify)

→ DISCUSS

If you could ask Sir Robert Grant a question about one of the lines or images in the hymn, what would it be?

WEEK 8 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 20

O Worship the King (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF, Bible

→ RECAP

Can you hum the melody of "O Worship the King"?

→ SING

Sing along with the hymn today.

∞ Video Link: O Worship the King (YouTube V1, V2, or Spotify)

→ READ & DISCUSS

- Sir Robert Grant was inspired by Psalm 104, or perhaps both Psalm 104 and a paraphrase of it from the 16th century by William Kethe (who wrote "All People That On Earth Do Dwell").
- Read Psalm 104:1-4 (or further if you like) and discuss the ways you see Grant working the ideas from the psalm into his poetry. Do you see echoes of any other Bible passages?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

The image of God riding upon the wind is common in both Scripture and in other hymns. If you learned "God Moves in a Mysterious Way" in Alveary hymn lessons last year, you might remember the line "he plants his footsteps in the sea and rides upon the storm." Look up Psalm 19, Isaiah 19, and Nahum 1 for other Bible passages with this imagery. Why do you think God is described this way?

WEEK 9 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 21

O Worship the King (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the connections between Psalm 104 and "O Worship the King"?

→ SING

Sing along with the tune, and then try singing "O Worship the King" acapella (just your voice). Feel free to use lyrics or not, and try to express the meaning of the song as you sing.

∞ Video Link: O Worship the King Tune

→ ILLUSTRATE (GRADES 1-6; OPTION 1 GRADES 7+)

Draw or paint an illustration of an image in the song.

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Term 2

→ WRITE (GRADES 7+ OPTION 2)

Compose an additional verse to "O Worship the King" drawn from an idea or image in Psalm 104.

WEEK 10 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 22

O Worship the King (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing "O Worship the King" from memory (as able).

→ SING

Look over any tricky places and sing through the song. Then try again without any lyrics (and see if you can see it from memory). Experiment with singing it faster or slower, and think about how you might want to sing each verse and refrain differently to emphasize the meaning. (For instance, you might sing the part about "thunder" very loudly and then get quiet when you sing about "frail children of dust.")

∞ Video Link: O Worship the King Tune

→ LISTEN

This is another popular tune for this hymn and also includes a few of the less popular verses. What do you think?

∞ Video Link: Alternate Tune

WEEK 11 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 23

Term Recap

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Hum a tune you know well to warm up your voice.

→ SING

Sing both the term's hymns as if you were a soloist (you may choose to sing with or without the accompaniment). If you wrote your own verse for "O Worship the King," sing it as well!

∞ Video Link: Angels We Have Heard Tune

∞ Video Link: O Worship the King Tune

WEEK 12 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Hymns & Spirituals

Hymns & Spirituals

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Term 3

WEEK 1 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 25

Hallelujah! What a Savior

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ INTRO

Have you ever heard the hymn, "It is Well with my Soul"? Philip Bliss was the author of that hymn and our next hymn this year, a popular Easter hymn.

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Read the hymn aloud and then listen to your preferred recording.

∞ Music Links: Hallelujah! What a Savior (YouTube or Spotify)

→ READ & DISCUSS

Our Hymn, Our Heritage "Text & Tune" p.70

∞ (Optional) Article Link: Additional History

• IMPORTANT DATES

Phillip Bliss (US, 1838-1876 AD)

"Hallelujah! What a Savior"
published (1875 AD)

WEEK 2 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 26

Hallelujah! What a Savior (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF, Globe/Atlas

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the history of our current hymn and its author?

→ SING

Hum a favorite tune to warm up your voice. Then alternate between listening to a verse and "hooing" for a verse (sing the tune on "hoo") to learn the tune.

∞ Music Links: Hallelujah! What a Savior (YouTube or Spotify)

→ PRACTICE

Continue learning the words. Read the whole song aloud. Write down the first line of each verse to help you remember the order, sketch a small illustration for each verse to help you visualize it, and do anything else you like to help yourself learn the words!

→ DISCUSS

Do you think there is a progression to the ideas in the hymn's verses? Describe how you think each verse builds (or doesn't build) on the previous ones. How would the hymn feel different if you changed the order?



Term 3

WEEK 3 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 27

Hallelujah! What a Savior (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Hum "Hallelujah! What a Savior."

→ SING

We'll put the words and tune together today! Listen to the song and pause it after each line to echo it back. Try to think about the meaning of the words as you sing.

∞ Video Links: Hallelujah! What a Savior (YouTube or Spotify)

→ DISCUSS

Where do you see Charles Wesley meditating on Scripture in this hymn? For instance, it seems like Isaiah 35:5-8 and a number of other scriptures must have been in the back of his head when he wrote verse 4.

∞ Article Link: Verse 4 References

WEEK 4 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 28

Hallelujah! What a Savior (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF, Bible

→ RECAP

What is your favorite verse of "Hallelujah! What a Savior"?

→ SING

Hum a hymn from last term to warm up your voice. Then sing with the accompaniment. Note any spots where you need to work more.

∞ Music Links: Hallelujah! What a Savior Tune

→ DISCUSS & READ

What Bible verses or stories do you hear echoed in the song? Can you find them in the Bible?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Here are a few chapters with relevant verses to read and discuss if needed.

Isaiah 53

Philippians 12

John 19

1 Peter 1

WEEK 5 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 29

Hallelujah! What a Savior (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Recite "Hallelujah! What a Savior" (as able). Remember to pay attention to the punctuation and not just the line breaks when you're saying rather than singing the hymn.

→ SING

Hymns & Spirituals

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

Hum a favorite tune to warm up your voice. Sing with the accompaniment and then try to sing the hymn without any recording. Can you sing it all from memory?

∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior Tune

→ VIEW (GRADES 5+)

Explore the book where our hymn was first published in 1875!

∞ Book Link: Gospel Hymns & Sacred Songs

WEEK 6 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 30

When Morning Gilds the Skies

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing "Hallelujah! What a Savior."

→ INTRO

- What was happening in the world during the 1800s? Tell about a few things you have learned in other subjects.
- Our last hymn for the year is from the mid-1800s. Don't forget that people have always sung these hymns in the midst of world events and the joys and struggles of everyday life – which you're learning about in other subjects!

→ SING & PRACTICE

Read the lyrics aloud, discuss unfamiliar words, and then listen to the full song (Note that the first version skips verse 3 in your lyrics, and the second version includes a 5th verse. So decide whether you'd like to learn three or five verses and adjust your lyrics accordingly.)

∞ Music Links: When Morning Gilds the Skies (YouTube V1, V2, or Spotify)

→ READ & DISCUSS

Learn the history of the song from your hymnal.

"Text & Tune" p.203

• IMPORTANT DATE

"When Morning Gilds the Skies" published (German: 1828 AD, English 1854 AD)

• TERMINOLOGY

- gild**: to cover with a thin layer of gold
- canticle**: song

Fun fact: The last quarter or so of the 19th century is sometimes called the "Gilded Age" in US history.

WEEK 7 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 31

When Morning Gilds the Skies (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF and US Atlas

→ RECAP & INTRO

What does "gild" mean? What is the author describing when he says "when morning gilds the skies"?

→ SING

Hum a favorite tune to warm up your voice. Then alternate between listening to a verse and "hoing" a verse to practice the tune.

∞ Music Links: When Morning Gilds the Skies (YouTube V1, V2, or Spotify)



Term 3

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read the lyrics aloud and pay close attention to the first line of each verse, as that is the orienting piece of each verse, since they all end with the same refrain.

→ EXPLORE

The first English translations of this hymn are quite long. Read through one or both. Why do you think the four verses we're learning are the most popular? Are there any other verses you particularly like? (Feel free to copy them in your notebook and learn them as well!)

∞ Book Link: Original Lyrics by Caswall

∞ Book Link: Yattendon Hymnal lyrics (Bridges lyrics)

WEEK 8 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 32

When Morning Gilds the Skies (cont.)

 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, Bible

→ RECAP

Can you hum the tune of "When Morning Gilds the Skies"?

→ SING

If you are feeling confident with the melody, sing the full song along with the recording. For any sections that you find difficult, pause your preferred recording after a line and echo it back.

∞ Music Links: When Morning Gilds the Skies (YouTube V1, V2, or Spotify)

→ DISCUSS

- Read 1 Corinthians 10:31. Perhaps the author thought of this verse when he wrote our hymn.
- If you wrote a new verse or two, what places or times would you include? Think of times when it's easy or hard to do everything to the glory of God. In a way, this hymn is a prayer you can pray as you sing - that in every situation you sing about, you would turn to Jesus and he would be praised.

WEEK 9 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 33

When Morning Gilds the Skies (cont.)

 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you sing the first verse lines of each verse of "When Morning Gilds the Skies"?

→ SING

Sing with the accompaniment (use the words in your PDF or hymnal as needed) and check your work. Go back and listen to the full song if needed.

∞ Video Link: When Morning Gilds the Skies Tune

Hymns & Spirituals

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Term 3

→ DISCUSS

Do you think there is a pattern to the verses? How would the song change if you rearranged them?

WEEK 10 📅 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 34

When Morning Gilds the Skies (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, painting or sketching supplies

→ RECAP

Orally or in writing, describe "When Morning Gilds the Skies" as if talking to a friend who hasn't heard of it.

→ SING

Hum a favorite tune to warm up your voice. Sing with the accompaniment recording and then try to sing the hymn without any recording. Can you sing it all from memory?

∞ Video Link: When Morning Gilds the Skies Tune

→ ILLUSTRATE

With remaining time or on your own time, paint an illustration to go along with the hymn.

WEEK 11 📅 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 35

Term Recap

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Hum a hymn from last term (or even last year!) to warm up your voice.

→ SING

Sing both of the term's hymns as if you were a soloist (you may choose to sing with or without the piano accompaniment).

∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior Tune

∞ Video Link: When Morning Gilds the Skies Tune

WEEK 12 📅 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Hymns & Spirituals

Hymns & Spirituals

Examination

- Term 1** · Sing "Children of the Heavenly Father" and tell what you know about the life and times of Carolina Berg.
- Term 2** · Sing "Angels We Have Heard on High" OR Draw or paint a new illustration to go with one of your hymns from this term. Underneath your work, write the line or verse from the hymn that your illustration reflects and write or tell why you chose the passage to illustrate.
- Term 3** · Sing "When Morning Gilds the Skies" and tell which verse is your favorite (or least favorite) and why.